

ALISTAIR V. STERLING, MBA

Senior Vice President of Global Operations & Supply Chain Transformation

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Visionary Operations Executive with over 12 years of high-impact experience orchestrating multi-billion dollar supply chain transformations within the Aerospace, Defense, and Advanced Manufacturing sectors. Renowned for architecting resilient global logistics frameworks that thrive in volatile geopolitical climates. Expert in the deployment of Industry 4.0 technologies, including AI-driven demand sensing, blockchain-enabled traceability, and large-scale robotic automation.

Distinguished for managing annual P&L responsibilities exceeding \$1.4B and leading diverse, cross-functional teams of 500+ professionals across four continents. Strategic architect of "Agile-Lean" methodologies that have consistently reduced operational overhead by 22%+ while maintaining 99.8%+ on-time delivery (OTD) performance for Tier-1 aerospace OEMs. Proven expertise in navigating the complexities of ITAR, EAR, and global trade compliance, ensuring seamless operations across international borders. A champion of digital transformation who bridges the gap between legacy industrial processes and cutting-edge autonomous technologies.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Global Strategic Leadership:** Multi-site Operations Management, Executive Stakeholder Engagement, Organizational Restructuring, M&A Integration.
- **Supply Chain Excellence:** End-to-End Visibility, Tier-1/Tier-2 Supplier Risk Mitigation, Global Sourcing Strategy, Strategic Partnering.
- **Operational Efficiency:** Lean Six Sigma Black Belt, Kaizen Blitz Methodology, Total Quality Management (TQM), Just-In-Time (JIT) Manufacturing.
- **Financial Stewardship:** Budgeting & Forecasting (\$1B+), Cost Reduction Strategies, Capex Planning, Working Capital Optimization.
- **Digital & Technical Innovation:** ERP Implementation (SAP S/4HANA), Warehouse Management Systems (WMS), Predictive Analytics, Robotics/AGVs.
- **Compliance & Governance:** ITAR/EAR Regulatory Frameworks, ESG Strategy, Global Trade Compliance, ISO 9001/AS9100 Quality Standards.
- **Risk Management:** Business Continuity Planning, Geopolitical Risk Modeling, Insurance & Liability Management, Supplier Diversification.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

VP of Global Supply Chain Operations | Apex Aerospace Systems | 2020 – Present

San Francisco, CA / Global (Leading Aerospace Components Manufacturer | Annual Revenue: \$8B)

Strategic Mandate: Directed the comprehensive supply chain strategy for 14 primary manufacturing facilities and 32 regional distribution centers. Accountable for a global procurement spend of \$2.2B and a direct workforce of 450+ logistics, procurement, and quality assurance

specialists.

Key Strategic Initiatives:

- **Supply Chain Resilience (The "Iron-Clad" Initiative):** In response to the 2021 global logistics crisis, redesigned the supplier network to reduce dependence on single-source components from 45% to 12%. This shift mitigated over \$450M in potential revenue loss during peak disruption periods.
- **Digital Transformation (Industry 4.0):** Spearheaded a \$120M digital overhaul, integrating IoT sensors across the manufacturing floor and syncing data with a central "Command Center" in SAP S/4HANA. Resulted in a 30% improvement in real-time inventory accuracy.
- **Global Procurement Consolidation:** Merged fragmented procurement departments from 4 acquired entities into a unified Global Sourcing Hub. Leveraged aggregated volume to negotiate \$85M in annual savings across raw materials (Titanium, Composites) and electronics.

Operational & Financial Outcomes:

- **Profitability:** Improved overall gross margins by 420 basis points through a combination of strategic sourcing and automated warehouse throughput.
- **Inventory Velocity:** Optimized "Days Sales of Inventory" (DSI) from 78 days to 54 days, freeing up \$115M in cash flow for reinvestment into R&D.
- **Supplier Performance:** Implemented an AI-based Supplier Scorecard system that automatically penalizes/rewards vendors based on quality (DPPM) and lead-time adherence; improved average vendor quality by 18%.
- **Sustainability Excellence:** Successfully transitioned the North American logistics fleet to 40% renewable fuel and achieved a 15% reduction in packaging waste through circular economy initiatives.

Leadership & Culture:

- Reorganized the global operations structure into "Center of Excellence" (CoE) units, increasing employee engagement scores by 25% over two years.
- Established the "Sterling Leadership Fellowship," a high-potential track that has successfully promoted 12 internal candidates to Director-level roles.

Director of Operations & Logistics | Horizon Dynamics | 2016 – 2020

Seattle, WA (Advanced Robotics and Defense Systems Integrator)

Strategic Mandate: Oversaw end-to-end operational lifecycles for complex defense contracts, including the production and deployment of autonomous reconnaissance units for the U.S. Department of Defense (DoD) and international allies (UK MoD, Australian ADF).

Operational Leadership:

- **Contract Fulfillment:** Managed the logistics for a \$1.2B multi-year contract for "Vanguard" robotic units. Ensured 100% delivery compliance across sensitive international borders under ITAR restrictions.
- **Cost Optimization:** Conducted a comprehensive audit of international freight lanes, identifying \$12M in annual redundancies. Renegotiated ocean and air contracts to achieve an 18% reduction in Total Landed Cost (TLC).
- **Quality Control:** Implemented a "Zero-Defect" culture in the Seattle assembly plant, utilizing Six Sigma DMAIC processes to reduce rework costs by \$4.5M annually.

Technology & Innovation:

- **WMS Implementation:** Led the ground-up deployment of Manhattan Associates WMS across 3 new high-security warehouses. System integration reduced picking errors to < 0.01%.
- **Predictive Maintenance:** Developed a predictive maintenance model for the manufacturing line that reduced unplanned downtime by 34%, saving an estimated \$2.1M in labor productivity.

Compliance & Risk:

- Served as the primary point of contact for government audits (DCMA/DCAA), achieving "Gold Status" ratings for logistics and inventory management for four consecutive years.
- Established a "Restricted Party Screening" automation that cut compliance review times from 4 hours to 10 minutes per shipment.

Senior Logistics Manager | Vertex Industrial Solutions | 2013 – 2016

Chicago, IL (Precision Machinery and Industrial Tooling)

Operational Mandate: Directed the North American distribution network, supporting 5 regional hubs and a network of 42 localized service centers. Focused on the "Last-Mile" delivery of critical precision parts for the automotive and energy sectors.

Key Achievements:

- **Dock-to-Stock Revolution:** Led a Kaizen event that redesigned the inbound receiving process. Reduced average processing time from 48 hours to 4.5 hours through the use of cross-docking and mobile scanning technology.
- **Reverse Logistics:** Created a "Circular Supply Chain" for high-value motor components. The program recovered \$12M in usable materials in its first year and reduced environmental footprint by 20%.
- **Carrier Management:** Managed a portfolio of 65 trucking and air-freight partners. Implemented a "Carrier Quality Index" (CQI) that resulted in a 15% improvement in on-time performance and a 5% reduction in transit damage rates.
- **Facility Expansion:** Project managed the commissioning of a \$45M, 500,000 sq. ft. distribution center in Dallas, TX. Delivered the facility 3 weeks ahead of schedule and 10% under budget.

Supply Chain Analyst | Omni-Global Logistics | 2011 – 2013

Dallas, TX (3PL Provider for High-Tech Electronics)

Core Responsibilities:

- Utilized advanced linear programming to optimize route density for a fleet of 200+ delivery vehicles.
- Conducted "What-If" scenario modeling for major clients like Zephyr Electronics and Apex Global.
- Assisted in the implementation of Oracle Transportation Management (OTM) modules.
- **Result:** Identified \$4M in obsolete inventory for a Tier-1 client, enabling a successful liquidation that recovered \$1.2M in capital.

KEY PROJECTS PORTFOLIO

Project Alpha: Global ERP Consolidation (SAP S/4HANA)

Role: Executive Sponsor & Functional Lead

Budget: \$115M

Duration: 24 Months

Complexity: Consolidated 12 legacy ERP systems (Oracle, Microsoft, Sage, and proprietary) into a single global instance for 15,000 users.

- **Challenge:** Fragmented data hindered real-time decision-making, leading to a \$50M inventory variance across global sites.
- **Action:** Defined the "Global Process Template" for all supply chain modules. Led a change management initiative involving 500+ training sessions.
- **Outcome:** Achieved a "Single Source of Truth" for data. Reduced monthly financial closing time by 6 days and eliminated \$35M in redundant software licensing and maintenance costs.

Project Beta: "Lights-Out" Warehouse Automation

Role: Project Director

Budget: \$60M

Location: Frankfurt, Germany

Technology: Autonomous Mobile Robots (AMRs), Automated Storage and Retrieval Systems (AS/RS).

- **Challenge:** High labor costs and a 12% error rate in the European distribution hub were impacting margins on high-volume aerospace fasteners.
- **Action:** Integrated 45 AMRs with the existing WMS. Implemented a "Good-to-Person" picking strategy.
- **Outcome:** Increased warehouse throughput by 300%. Reduced labor dependency by 65% and achieved an unprecedented 99.995% picking accuracy. The site now serves as the global benchmark for automation.

Project Gamma: Blockchain Traceability for Critical Components

Role: Innovation Lead

Partners: IBM Food Trust (adapted), Ethereum Enterprise Alliance.

- **Challenge:** Preventing "Counterfeit, Fraudulent, and Suspect Items" (CFSI) from entering the aerospace supply chain.
- **Action:** Developed a blockchain ledger that tracks a component from raw ore to final installation. Secured participation from 50+ critical suppliers.
- **Outcome:** Reduced FAA audit response time from 10 days to 2 minutes. Eliminated the risk of uncertified parts entering the production line, protecting multi-billion dollar airworthiness certifications.

Project Delta: Sustainable Aviation Fuel (SAF) Logistics Bridge

Role: Executive Lead

Outcome: Secured a long-term supply of SAF for Apex's internal testing fleet, reducing corporate carbon emissions by 18%. Negotiated first-of-their-kind logistics contracts for specialized SAF handling and storage.

PROCESS IMPROVEMENT CASE STUDIES

Case Study 1: Lead Time Reduction in Specialty Composites

- **Problem:** Procurement lead times for high-grade carbon fiber reached an all-time high of 42 weeks, threatening the launch of the "Aero-X" program.
- **Intervention:** Initiated a "Supplier Development Program." Co-invested with a Tier-2 supplier to upgrade their manufacturing capacity in exchange for guaranteed volume and price caps.
- **Result:** Reduced lead time to 16 weeks (a 62% reduction). Saved the program from a projected \$20M late-delivery penalty.

Case Study 2: Working Capital Optimization (The "Cash-is-King" Project)

- **Problem:** Apex Aerospace had \$1.1B tied up in raw material inventory, exceeding industry benchmarks by 25%.
- **Intervention:** Transitioned top 20 suppliers to a Vendor Managed Inventory (VMI) model with "Consignment Stock" triggers.
- **Result:** Improved "Days Payable Outstanding" (DPO) by 15 days and reduced on-hand inventory value by \$210M without affecting production uptime.

Case Study 3: Global Freight Lane Re-Architecture

- **Problem:** Fragmented air-freight usage resulted in \$45M annual spend with localized premiums and inconsistent reliability across APAC-NA lanes.
- **Intervention:** Consolidated 14 carriers into a primary "Strategic Alliance" model with 3 key partners. Implemented a "Fixed Capacity" agreement for peak seasons.
- **Result:** Secured a \$9.2M annual reduction in freight spend while improving transit time consistency by 34%.

LEADERSHIP & TEAM MANAGEMENT

- **The "Extreme Ownership" Model:** Cultivate a culture where team leaders are empowered to make localized decisions while remaining aligned with global strategic objectives.
- **Talent Development:** Managed a personal mentorship portfolio of 15 high-potential executives. Developed a "Supply Chain Academy" internal training program that has certified 200+ employees in Lean methodologies.
- **Global Collaboration:** Expertise in managing multi-cultural teams across the US, EU, and APAC. Fluent in navigating different labor laws, cultural norms, and business ethics.
- **Cross-Functional Integration:** Proven ability to break down silos between Engineering, Finance, Sales, and Operations to ensure a "Total Business" approach to supply chain management.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & TOOLS

Enterprise Architecture:

- **ERP:** SAP S/4HANA (Expert), Oracle Cloud EPM, Microsoft Dynamics 365.
- **WMS/TMS:** Manhattan Active WM, Blue Yonder TMS, SAP EWM, Kuehne+Nagel Control Tower.
- **Advanced Planning:** Kinaxis RapidResponse, Blue Yonder Demand Planning, OMP.

Data & Analytics:

- **BI Tools:** Tableau, Power BI, QlikView, Looker.
- **Programming/Modeling:** Python (Data Science libraries), SQL, R, AnyLogistix (Supply Chain Digital Twins).
- **Automation:** UiPath (RPA Architect), Blue Prism, ServiceNow.

Methodologies & Standards:

- **Frameworks:** SCOR Model, APICS Dictionary, ITIL, Agile/Scrum.
- **Compliance:** ITAR, EAR, REACH, RoHS, C-TPAT, AEO Certification.
- **Production:** Toyota Production System (TPS), TPM, OEE Optimization, SMED.

STRATEGIC COMPLIANCE & GOVERNANCE

- **ITAR/EAR Compliance Officer:** Served as the designated executive lead for export controls at Horizon Dynamics. Successfully navigated 3 major federal audits with zero citations.
- **Global Trade Strategy:** Designed a "Duty Drawback" program that recovered \$5.5M in over-paid tariffs for international shipments.
- **Sustainability Governance:** Lead the "Green Supply Chain" council, setting science-based targets (SBTi) for Scope 3 emission reductions across the Tier-1 supplier base.
- **Ethics & Diversity:** Implemented a "Supplier Diversity Program" that redirected \$150M in annual spend toward minority-owned and small business enterprises, exceeding corporate social responsibility goals by 20%.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA) in Global Operations & Finance

Stanford Graduate School of Business, Palo Alto, CA

- Focus: Global Macroeconomics, Supply Chain Risk Modeling, Venture Capital.
- Leadership: President of the Operations & Technology Club.

Bachelor of Science in Industrial & Systems Engineering

Georgia Institute of Technology (Georgia Tech), Atlanta, GA

- Concentration: Supply Chain Engineering, Stochastic Modeling.
- Honors: Summa Cum Laude, President's Undergraduate Research Award.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **CSCP:** Certified Supply Chain Professional – ASCM (APICS)
- **LSSBB:** Lean Six Sigma Black Belt – American Society for Quality (ASQ)
- **PMP:** Project Management Professional – Project Management Institute (PMI)
- **CTL:** Certified in Transportation and Logistics – AST&L
- **Executive Certificate:** Digital Transformation in Supply Chain – MIT Sloan
- **CPSM:** Certified Professional in Supply Management – ISM
- **Strategic Negotiations:** Advanced Certification – Harvard Law Program on Negotiation

BOARD MEMBERSHIPS & VOLUNTEER LEADERSHIP

- **Board Member:** Council of Supply Chain Management Professionals (CSCMP) – NorCal Chapter (2021 – Present).
- **Advisory Board:** Silicon Valley Robotics (Focus on Industrial Automation Standards).
- **Volunteer Mentor:** "Veterans in Tech" – Providing career transition coaching for military logistics officers.
- **Guest Lecturer:** UC Berkeley Haas School of Business – "Advanced Global Logistics & Geopolitical Risk."
- **Industry Advisor:** Stanford Smart Logistics Lab – Collaborative research on AI-driven warehouse pick-path optimization.

PUBLICATIONS & CONFERENCES

Selected Publications

- **"The Resilience Index: Measuring Supply Chain Stability in the Age of Geopolitical Volatility"**
Supply Chain Management Review (SCMR), Issue 4, 2023.
- **"Beyond the Hype: Practical Applications of Blockchain in Aerospace Logistics"**
Journal of Advanced Manufacturing Technology, 2022.
- **"Digital Twins: The Final Frontier of Inventory Optimization"**
Logistics Quarterly, 2021.
- **"The Future of ITAR: Managing Compliance in a Cloud-Native World"**
Defense Logistics Journal, Spring Edition, 2020.

Keynote Presentations

- **Keynote:** "Autonomous Supply Chains: From Vision to Reality," *Gartner Supply Chain Symposium/Xpo*, 2023.
- **Featured Speaker:** "Decarbonizing the Aerospace Value Chain," *World Economic Forum (Davos - Satellite Event)*, 2022.
- **Panelist:** "Navigating the New Normal: Trade Compliance in a Bipolar World," *Global Trade Professionals Alliance (GTPA)*, 2021.
- **Workshop Lead:** "Lean Six Sigma for Defense Contractors," *Aero-Defense Manufacturing Expo*, 2019.

LANGUAGES & GLOBAL EXPOSURE

- **English:** Native Proficiency.
- **German:** Professional Working Proficiency (C1 Level) – Developed during Frankfurt DC Project.
- **Spanish:** Conversational.
- **Global Footprint:** Managed operations/suppliers in: USA, Mexico, Germany, UK, France, Singapore, China, India, and Australia.

STRATEGIC VISION & LEADERSHIP STATEMENT

Operational Philosophy

In the modern industrial landscape, "Efficiency" is no longer the sole metric of success. My leadership philosophy is built on the pillar of **Resilient Efficiency**. This approach acknowledges that while cost-optimization is vital for shareholder value, a supply chain that cannot withstand a Tier-3 supplier failure or a sudden geopolitical shift is a liability, not an asset. By integrating digital twins and real-time visibility tools, I empower my teams to foresee disruptions before they impact the P&L.

Future Outlook

The next decade of aerospace operations will be defined by the convergence of sustainable propulsion and autonomous logistics. My mission is to position Apex Aerospace Systems as the global leader in this transition, ensuring that our logistics network is as innovative as the propulsion systems we manufacture.

Commitment to Excellence

Whether leading a \$60M warehouse automation project or negotiating a complex ITAR compliance framework, my commitment remains the same: total operational integrity, unwavering safety standards, and the relentless pursuit of perfection in every component we ship.